

Introduction

Human history is crammed full of incidents, from civilizations rising and falling as wars are fought and lost, to revolutions sweeping away the past to begin again. There has also been great architecture and many important innovations, from the first stone tools that enabled people to hunt animals to radio telescopes that can “see” into deep space.

The Great Sphinx
This statue at Giza, in Egypt, has a human head on a lion's body. It is thought to have been made about 4,500 years ago.

